

Ark of the Covenant

This document describes the **Ark of the Covenant**, a sacred chest built by the Israelites according to God's instructions. It details its construction, contents, and significance.

- **Construction and Design:** The Ark was made of shittim wood, overlaid with gold, and had a crown of gold around it. It was equipped with rings and staves for carrying.
- **Contents:** The Ark contained the two stone tablets of the Ten Commandments, also known as the Testimony.
- **Symbolism and Significance:** The Ark represented God's presence and glory. It was considered the glory of Israel and was holy, sanctifying its resting place.
- **Location and Movement:** The Ark was kept in the Holy of Holies, the most sacred part of the Tabernacle and later the Temple. It was carried by priests or Levites and was sometimes brought to the battlefield.
- **Miracles and Events:** The Ark was associated with several miracles, including the parting of the Jordan River, the fall of Jericho's walls, and the destruction of the Philistine idol Dagon.
- **Profanation and Protection:** Mishandling the Ark resulted in punishment, while protecting it brought blessings.
- **Type of Christ:** The Ark is seen as a type of Christ, representing His obedience and the fulfillment of God's law.

The document provides a comprehensive overview of the Ark of the Covenant, emphasizing its importance in Israelite history and its connection to God's presence and power.

Ark of the Covenant

Dimensions, ect. of.

Exodus 25:10 And they shall make an ark of shittim wood: two cubits and a half shall be the length thereof, and a cubit and a half the breadth thereof, and a cubit and a half the height thereof.

Exodus 37:1 And Bezaleel made the ark of shittim wood: two cubits and a half was the length of it, and a cubit and a half the breadth of it, and a cubit and a half the height of it:

Entirely covered with gold.

Exodus 25:11 And thou shalt overlay it with pure gold, within and without shalt thou overlay it, and shalt make upon it a crown of gold round about.

Exodus 37:2 And he overlaid it with pure gold within and without, and made a crown of gold to it round about. Surrounded with a crown of gold.

Exodus 25:11 And thou shalt overlay it with pure gold, within and without shalt thou overlay it, and shalt make upon it a crown of gold round about.

Furnished with rings and staves.

Exodus 25:12-15 And thou shalt cast four rings of gold for it, and put them in the four corners thereof; and two rings shall be in the one side of it, and two rings in the other side of it. 13 And thou shalt make staves of shittim wood, and overlay them with gold. 14 And thou shalt put the staves into the rings by the sides of the ark, that the ark may be borne with them. 15 The staves shall be in the rings of the ark: they shall not be taken from it.

Exodus 37:3-5 And he cast for it four rings of gold, to be set by the four corners of it; even two rings upon the one side of it, and two rings upon the other side of it. 4 And he made staves of shittim wood, and overlaid them with gold. 5 And he put the staves into the rings by the sides of the ark, to bear the ark.

Tables of testimony alone placed in.

Exodus 25:16 And thou shalt put into the ark the testimony which I shall give thee.

Exodus 25:21 And thou shalt put the Mercy Seat above upon the ark; and in the ark thou shalt put the testimony that I shall give thee.

1 Kings 8:9 There was nothing in the ark save the two tables of stone, which Moses put there at Horeb, when the LORD made a covenant with the children of Israel, when they came out of the land of Egypt.

1 Kings 8:21 And I have set there a place for the ark, wherein is the covenant of the LORD, which he made with our Fathers, when he brought them out of the land of Egypt.

2 Chronicles 5:10 There was nothing in the ark save the two tables which Moses put therein at Horeb, when the LORD made a covenant with the children of Israel, when they came out of Egypt.

Hebrews 9:4 Which had the golden censer, and the Ark of the Covenant overlaid round about with gold, wherein was the golden pot that had manna, and Aaron's rod that budded, and the tables of the covenant;

Mercy-seat laid upon.

Exodus 25:21 And thou shalt put the Mercy Seat above upon the ark; and in the ark thou shalt put the testimony that I shall give thee.

Exodus 26:34 And thou shalt put the Mercy Seat upon the ark of the testimony in the Most Holy Place.

Placed in the Holy of Holies.

Exodus 26:33 And thou shalt hang up The Vail under the taches, that thou mayest bring in thither within The Vail the ark of the testimony: and The Vail shall divide unto you between the Holy Place and the most holy.

Exodus 40:21 And he brought the ark into The Tabernacle, and set up The Vail of the covering, and covered the ark of the testimony; as the LORD commanded Moses.

Hebrews 9:3-4 And after the second veil, The Tabernacle which is called the Holiest of all; 4 Which had the golden censer, and the Ark of the Covenant overlaid round about with gold, wherein was the golden pot that had manna, and Aaron's rod that budded, and the tables of the covenant;

The pot of manna and Aaron's rod laid up before.

Hebrews 9:4 Which had the golden censer, and the Ark of the Covenant overlaid round about with gold, wherein was the golden pot that had manna, and Aaron's rod that budded, and the

tables of the covenant;

Exodus 16:33-34 And Moses said unto Aaron, Take a pot, and put an omer full of manna therein, and lay it up before the LORD, to be kept for your generations. 34 As the LORD commanded Moses, so Aaron laid it up before the Testimony, to be kept.

A copy of The Law laid in the side of.

Deuteronomy 31:26 Take this book of The Law, and put it in the side of the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD your God, that it may be there for a Witness against thee.

Anointed with sacred oil.

Exodus 30:26 And thou shalt anoint The Tabernacle of the Congregation therewith, and the ark of the testimony,

Covered with The Vail by the priests before removal.

Numbers 4:5-6 And when the camp setteth forward, Aaron shall come, and his sons, and they shall take down the covering vail, and cover the ark of testimony with it: 6 And shall put thereon the covering of badgers' skins, and shall spread over it a cloth wholly of blue, and shall put in the staves thereof.

WAS CALLED THE

Ark of God.

1 Samuel 3:3 And ere the lamp of God went out in the temple of the LORD, where the ark of God was, and Samuel was laid down to sleep;

Ark of God's strength.

2 Chronicles 6:41 Now therefore arise, O LORD God, into thy resting place, thou, and the ark of thy strength: let thy priests, O LORD God, be clothed with Salvation, and let thy Saints rejoice in goodness.

Psalms 132:8 Arise, O LORD, into thy rest; thou, and the ark of thy strength.

Ark of the Covenant of the Lord.

Numbers 10:33 And they departed from the mount of the LORD three days' journey: and the

Ark of the Covenant of the LORD went before them in the three days' journey, to search out a resting place for them.

Ark of the testimony.

Exodus 30:6 And thou shalt put it before The Vail that is by the ark of the testimony, before the Mercy Seat that is over the testimony, where I will meet with thee.

Numbers 7:89 And when Moses was gone into The Tabernacle of the Congregation to speak with him, then he heard the voice of one speaking unto him from off the Mercy Seat that was upon the ark of testimony, from between the two Cherubims: and he spake unto him.

A symbol of the presence and glory of God.

Numbers 14:43-44 For the Amalekites and the Canaanites are there before you, and ye shall fall by the sword: because ye are turned away from the LORD, therefore the LORD will not be with you. 44 But they presumed to go up unto the hill top: nevertheless the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD, and Moses, departed not out of the camp.

Esteemed the glory of Israel.

1 Samuel 4:21-22 And she named the child Ichabod, saying, The glory is departed from Israel: because the ark of God was taken, and because of her Father in law and her husband. 22 And she said, The glory is departed from Israel: for the ark of God is taken.

Was holy.

2 Chronicles 35:3 And said unto the Levites that taught all Israel, which were holy unto the LORD, Put the holy ark in the house which Solomon the son of David king of Israel did build; it shall not be a burden upon your shoulders: serve now the LORD your God, and his people Israel,

Sanctified its resting-place.

2 Chronicles 8:11 And Solomon brought up the daughter of Pharaoh out of the city of David unto the house that he had built for her: for he said, My wife shall not dwell in the house of David king of Israel, because the places are holy, whereunto the ark of the LORD hath come.

The Israelites inquired of the Lord before.

Joshua 7:6-9 And Joshua rent his clothes, and fell to the earth upon his face before the ark of the LORD until the eventide, he and the elders of Israel, and put dust upon their heads. 7 And Joshua said, Alas, O Lord GOD, wherefore hast thou at all brought this people over Jordan, to deliver us into the hand of the Amorites, to destroy us? would to God we had been content, and dwelt on the other side Jordan! 8 O Lord, what shall I say, when Israel turneth their backs before their enemies! 9 For the Canaanites and all the inhabitants of the land shall hear of it, and shall environ us round, and cut off our name from the earth: and what wilt thou do unto thy great name?

Judges 20:27 And the children of Israel inquired of the LORD, (for the Ark of the Covenant of God was there in those days,

1 Chronicles 13:3 And let us bring again the ark of our God to us: for we inquired not at it in the days of Saul.

WAS CARRIED

By priests of Levites alone.

Deuteronomy 10:8 At that time the LORD separated the tribe of Levi, to bear the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD, to stand before the LORD to minister unto him, and to bless in his name, unto this day.

Joshua 3:14 And it came to pass, when the people removed from their tents, to pass over Jordan, and the priests bearing the Ark of the Covenant before the people;

2 Samuel 15:24 And lo Zadok also, and all the Levites were with him, bearing the Ark of the Covenant of God: and they set down the ark of God; and Abiathar went up, until all the people had done passing out of the city.

1 Chronicles 15:2 Then David said, None ought to carry the ark of God but the Levites: for them hath the LORD Chosen to carry the ark of God, and to minister unto him for ever.

Before the Israelites in their journeys.

Numbers 10:33 And they departed from the mount of the LORD three days' journey: and the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD went before them in the three days' journey, to search out a resting place for them.

Joshua 3:6 And Joshua spake unto the priests, saying, Take up the Ark of the Covenant, and pass over before the people. And they took up the Ark of the Covenant, and went before the people.

Sometimes to the camp in war.

1 Samuel 4:4-5 So the people sent to Shiloh, that they might bring from thence the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD of hosts, which dwelleth between the Cherubims: and the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were there with the Ark of the Covenant of God. 5 And when the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD came into the camp, all Israel shouted with a great shout, so that the earth rang again.

Profanation of, Punished.

Numbers 4:5 And when the camp setteth forward, Aaron shall come, and his sons, and they shall take down the covering vail, and cover the ark of testimony with it:

Numbers 4:15 And when Aaron and his sons have made an end of covering the sanctuary, and all the vessels of the sanctuary, as the camp is to set forward; after that, the sons of Kohath shall come to bear it: but they shall not touch any holy thing, lest they die. These things are the burden of the sons of Kohath in The Tabernacle of the Congregation.

1 Samuel 6:19 And he smote the men of Bethshemesh, because they had looked into the ark of the LORD, even he smote of the people fifty thousand and threescore and ten men: and the people lamented, because the LORD had smitten many of the people with a great slaughter.

1 Chronicles 15:13 For because ye did it not at the first, the LORD our God made a Breach upon us, for that we sought him not after the due order.

Protecting of, rewarded.

1 Chronicles 13:14 And the ark of God remained with the family of Obededom in his house

three months. And the LORD blessed the house of Obbededom, and all that he had.

Captured by the Philistines.

1 Samuel 4:11 And the ark of God was taken; and the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were slain.

Miracles CONNECTED WITH
Jordan divided.

Joshua 4:7 Then ye shall answer them, That the waters of Jordan were cut off before the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD; when it passed over Jordan, the waters of Jordan were cut off: and these stones shall be for a memorial unto the children of Israel for ever.

Fall of the walls of Jericho.

Joshua 6:6-20 And Joshua the son of Nun called the priests, and said unto them, Take up the Ark of the Covenant, and let seven priests bear Seven Trumpets of rams' horns before the ark of the LORD. 7 And he said unto the people, Pass on, and Compass the city, and let him that is armed pass on before the ark of the LORD. 8 And it came to pass, when Joshua had spoken unto the people, that the seven priests bearing the Seven Trumpets of rams' horns passed on before the LORD, and blew with the trumpets: and the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD followed them. 9 And the armed men went before the priests that blew with the trumpets, and the rereward came after the ark, the priests going on, and blowing with the trumpets. ...

Fall of Dagon.

1 Samuel 5:1-4 And the Philistines took the ark of God, and brought it from Ebenezer unto Ashdod. 2 When the Philistines took the ark of God, they brought it into the house of Dagon, and set it by Dagon. 3 And when they of Ashdod arose early on the morrow, behold, Dagon was fallen upon his face to the earth before the ark of the LORD. And they took Dagon, and set him in his place again. 4 And when they arose early on the morrow morning, behold, Dagon was fallen upon his face to the ground before the ark of the LORD; and the head of Dagon and both the palms of his hands were cut off upon the threshold; only the stump of Dagon was left

to him.

Philistines plagued.

1 Samuel 5:6-12 But the hand of the LORD was heavy upon them of Ashdod, and he destroyed them, and smote them with emerods, even Ashdod and the coasts thereof. 7 And when the men of Ashdod saw that it was so, they said, The ark of the God of Israel shall not abide with us: for his hand is sore upon us, and upon Dagon our god. 8 They sent therefore and gathered all the lords of the Philistines unto them, and said, What shall we do with the ark of the God of Israel? And they answered, Let the ark of the God of Israel be carried about unto Gath. And they carried the ark of the God of Israel about thither. 9 And it was so, that, after they had carried it about, the hand of the LORD was against the city with a very great destruction: and he smote the men of the city, both small and great, and they had emerods in their secret parts.

...

Manner of its restoration.

1 Samuel 6:1-18 And the ark of the LORD was in the country of the Philistines seven months. 2 And the Philistines called for the priests and the diviners, saying, What shall we do to the ark of the LORD? tell us wherewith we shall send it to his place. 3 And they said, If ye send away the ark of the God of Israel, send it not empty; but in any wise return him a Trespass Offering: then ye shall be healed, and it shall be known to you why his hand is not removed from you. 4 Then said they, What shall be the Trespass Offering which we shall return to him? They answered, Five golden emerods, and five golden mice, according to the number of the lords of the Philistines: for one plague was on you all, and on your lords. ...

At Kirjath-jearim twenty years.

1 Samuel 7:1-2 And the men of Kirjathjearim came, and fetched up the ark of the LORD, and brought it into the house of Abinadab in the hill, and sanctified Eleazar his son to keep the ark of the LORD. 2 And it came to pass, while the ark Abode in Kirjathjearim, that the time was long; for it was twenty years: and all the house of Israel lamented after the LORD.

Removed from Kirjath-jearim to the house of Obed-Edom.

2 Samuel 6:1-11 Again, David gathered together all the Chosen men of Israel, thirty thousand. 2 And David arose, and went with all the people that were with him from Baale of Judah, to bring up from thence the ark of God, whose name is called by the name of the LORD of hosts that dwelleth between the Cherubims. 3 And they set the ark of God upon a new cart, and brought it out of the house of Abinadab that was in Gibeah: and Uzzah and Ahio, the sons of Abinadab, drave the new cart. 4 And they brought it out of the house of Abinadab which was at Gibeah, accompanying the ark of God: and Ahio went before the ark. ...

David made a tent for.

2 Samuel 6:17 And they brought in the ark of the LORD, and set it in his place, in the midst of The Tabernacle that David had pitched for it: and David offered Burnt Offerings and Peace Offerings before the LORD.

1 Chronicles 15:1 And David made him houses in the city of David, and prepared a place for the ark of God, and pitched for it a tent.

Brought into the city of David.

2 Samuel 6:12-15 And it was told king David, saying, The LORD hath blessed the house of Obbedom, and all that pertaineth unto him, because of the ark of God. So David went and brought up the ark of God from the house of Obbedom into the city of David with gladness.

13 And it was so, that when they that bare the ark of the LORD had gone six paces, he sacrificed oxen and fatlings. 14 And David danced before the LORD with all his might; and David was girded with a linen ephod. 15 So David and all the house of Israel brought up the ark of the LORD with shouting, and with the sound of the trumpet.

1 Chronicles 15:25-28 So David, and the elders of Israel, and the Captains over thousands, went to bring up the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD out of the house of Obbedom with joy. 26 And it came to pass, when God helped the Levites that bare the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD, that they offered seven bullocks and seven rams. 27 And David was clothed with a robe

of fine linen, and all the Levites that bare the ark, and the singers, and Chenaniah the master of the song with the singers: David also had upon him an ephod of linen. 28 Thus all Israel brought up the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD with shouting, and with sound of the Cornet, and with trumpets, and with cymbals, making a noise with psalteries and Harps. Brought by Solomon into the temple with great solemnity.

1 Kings 8:1-6 Then Solomon assembled the elders of Israel, and all the heads of the tribes, the chief of the Fathers of the children of Israel, unto king Solomon in Jerusalem, that they might bring up the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD out of the city of David, which is Zion. 2 And all the men of Israel assembled themselves unto king Solomon at the feast in the month Ethanim, which is the seventh month. 3 And all the elders of Israel came, and the priests took up the ark. 4 And they brought up the ark of the LORD, and The Tabernacle of the Congregation, and all the holy vessels that were in The Tabernacle, even those did the priests and the Levites bring up. ...

2 Chronicles 5:2-9 Then Solomon assembled the elders of Israel, and all the heads of the tribes, the chief of the Fathers of the children of Israel, unto Jerusalem, to bring up the Ark of the Covenant of the LORD out of the city of David, which is Zion. 3 Wherefore all the men of Israel assembled themselves unto the king in the feast which was in the seventh month. 4 And all the elders of Israel came; and the Levites took up the ark. 5 And they brought up the ark, and The Tabernacle of the Congregation, and all the holy vessels that were in The Tabernacle, these did the priests and the Levites bring up. ...

A type of Christ.

Psalms 40:8 I delight to do thy will, O my God: yea, thy law is within my heart.

Revelation 11:19 And the temple of God was opened in heaven, and there was seen in his temple the ark of his testament: and there were lightnings, and voices, and thunderings, and an Earthquake, and great hail.